Name: .....

ID: .....

AOU
الجامعة العربية المفتوحة
Arab Open University

Arab Open University
FACULTY OF LANGUAGE STUDIES
EL117
Academic Writing
All Branches
Final Exam

2024-2025 /Spring
Date: 4 June 2025
9:30 – 11:30

Section No. _____

Number of Exam Pages: 11 (including this cover sheet)	**Time Allowed: 2 hours**

INSTRUCTION

There are THREE sections in this exam paper:

1. You are required to answer ALL the sections.
2. In section 1, apply the learned skills for writing focus by answering few analytical questions related to unity, cohesion, structure, and mechanics of writing.
3. In section 2, choose only one topic and outline a five-paragraph essay.
4. In section 3, write a standard essay: start with an introduction, develop well-written body paragraphs, and end with a concluding paragraph. After you finish writing your essay, edit and proofread it paying attention to grammar, punctuation, and spelling.
5. Cross out any notes you make which you do not want to be considered.
6. Devote 5 minutes for reading through the whole paper and making the appropriate selection of questions.

Grades:

Question Number	Minutes	Mark allocated (per question)	Earned Mark	Marker's Initials & Signature
Section I: Writing Focus & Editing	40	20		
Section II: Essay Outlining	20	5		
Section III: Essay Writing	60	25		
Total in Figures		50		
Total in Letters	120 Minutes	Fifty Marks		

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Section	1	Writing Focus & Editing	20 POINTS	40 MINUTES

I. Choose the right answer from a, b, c or d. *(1 point each)*

1. Which of the following is NOT a fragmented sentence?

a. To study for the exam before the weekend.
b. During the summer vacation.
c. Although it was raining heavily.
d. The teacher asked the students to submit their projects.

2. Which connectors indicate a contrast relationship?

a. because, so, therefore
b. for example, such as, like
c. although, however, on the other hand
d. similarly, likewise, in addition

3. Which of the following is a key characteristic of a comparison and contrast essay?

a. Explaining the steps of a process
b. Presenting two or more subjects and highlighting their similarities and differences
c. Arguing for or against a particular issue
d. Describing a personal experience in detail

4. Choose the grammatically correct revision for the following sentence: *The students studied late into the night. They knew their final exam was important.*

a. The students studied late into the night, they knew their final exam was important.
b. The students studied late into the night; they knew their final exam was important.
c. The students studied late into the night: they knew their final exam was important.
d. The students studied late into the night. They knew, their final exam was important.

5. For the sentences below, choose the best revision that is grammatically correct.

a. The documentary highlights the struggles of the community, it also showcases their resilience.
b. The documentary highlights the struggles of the community; also, it showcases their resilience.
c. The documentary highlights the struggles of the community, and, also showcases their resilience.
d. The documentary highlights the struggles of the community and it also showcases their resilience.

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6. What rhetorical pattern is common in an essay that provides vivid details about a sunset over the ocean?

a. Narration
b. Cause and effect
c. Argumentation
d. Comparison

7. Cause and effect paragraphs would best be used for an essay that .....

a. examines the impact of social media on teenagers' mental health.
b. narrates the story of a family's move to a new city.
c. compares the different methods of cooking pasta.
d. describes the scenery during a hiking trip in the mountains.

8. In a passage describing a historical event, the author provides vivid details about the setting, key figures, and emotions of the time period. This approach is an example of .....

a. argument
b. narration
c. cause and effect
d. comparison

9. Which sentence shows a similarity??

a. Unlike most mammals, whales live their entire lives in water.
b. The weather was unpredictable, shifting from sunny to rainy within hours.
c. The artist's new painting was vastly different from his previous work.
d. Both online and in-person classes require students to complete assignments and participate in discussions.

10. Which sentence shows an argument?

a. Technology has changed the way people communicate in the modern world.
b. Schools should incorporate more technology in classrooms to enhance student learning.
c. Many people use smartphones for work and personal communication.
d. The invention of the internet has had a major impact on society.

11. Which sentence demonstrates correct apostrophe usage?

a. The teachers lounges' is located on the second floor.
b. She borrowed her sisters' dress for the event.
c. It's important to stay hydrated during hot weather.
d. The cars' engine needs to be replaced.

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12. Choose the most appropriate thesis statement for an argument essay.

a. Many students prefer online education because of its flexibility.
b. Online education has grown in popularity due to technological advancements.
c. Online education provides students with greater flexibility and access to learning resources, making it a viable alternative to traditional classrooms.
d. Some universities offer both online and in-person classes to accommodate students' needs.

13. Which statement provides the most relevant evidence for the thesis " *Regular exercise improves mental health*"?

a. Exercise can help reduce symptoms of anxiety and depression.
b. Many people enjoy outdoor activities like running and cycling.
c. Regular exercise is often recommended for weight management.
d. People who exercise are more likely to maintain a balanced diet.

14. Which sentence demonstrates correct subject-verb agreement?

a. The list of participants were posted on the bulletin board.
b. Neither of the options are suitable for the project.
c. The team of researchers is presenting their findings today.
d. My brother and my sister enjoys playing board games together.

15. Which sentence demonstrates correct parallel structure?

a. She wants to learn coding, improving her writing, and to travel abroad.
b. He spends his weekends either playing soccer or he goes swimming.
c. The new policy aims to reduce costs, increasing efficiency, and to improve customer satisfaction.
d. The company focuses on hiring skilled workers, providing training, and maintaining a positive work environment.

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II. II. Evaluate each of the following thesis statements as Correct or Incorrect.

(1 point each)

1. "Shakespeare's plays are outdated and have no relevance to modern society."

   _____

2. "Climate change poses a significant threat to global ecosystems and requires immediate policy action to mitigate its effects."

   _____

3. "People who watch too much TV are lazy and unproductive."

   _____

4. "Social movements driven by digital activism can influence political change and raise awareness about important issues."

   _____

5. "Everyone should avoid using technology."

   _____

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Section	2	Outlining	5 POINTS	20 MINUTES

Outline ONE of the following topics by filling in the graphic organizer below. ***(5 points)***

1. Should primary education be free for all students? Examine the potential benefits and drawbacks of providing free education for the primary stage, including its impact on accessibility, quality of education, and the economy. Provide evidence from countries that offer free or low-cost primary education.

2. Compare and contrast the productivity, mental well-being, and job satisfaction of employees working remotely with those working in traditional office environments. Provide evidence and examples that have adopted remote work policies. Use specific examples and evidence to support your discussion. Give detailed explanation following point-by-point comparison.

Introductory Paragraph: ***(1 point)***

Hook/Opening statement:

Thesis statement:

Body Paragraph (1): ***(1 point)***

Topic sentence (1):

Major supporting details:

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Body Paragraph (2): ***(1 point)***

Topic sentence (2):

Major supporting details:

Body Paragraph (3): ***(1 point)***

Topic sentence (3):

Major supporting details:

Concluding Paragraph: ***(1 point)***

Restatement of the thesis:

Final comment:

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Section	3	Essay Writing	25 POINTS	60 MINUTES

Write a five-paragraph essay (400-450 words) on the same topic that you have outlined in the previous section. **(25 points)**

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